

Lesson 3.1 – Identifying Branches to Prune

Types of Branches to Remove

1. Dead branches

- No leaves
- Brittle and dry

2. Diseased branches

- Discoloration
- Fungus or unusual spots

3. Damaged branches

- Broken or cracked

4. Weak branches

- Thin and poorly attached
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Example

A guava tree with mixed branch conditions:

- Dead branch → no growth
- Healthy branch → green and flexible

Removing the dead branch allows the tree to focus energy on healthy growth.

What to Do

Inspect the tree carefully

Prioritize unhealthy branches

Mark branches before cutting

Lesson 3.2 – Making Your First Cut

Steps for Beginners

1. Choose the correct tool
 2. Locate the branch to remove
 3. Position tool at a **45° angle**
 4. Cut in one smooth motion
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Important Tip

Avoid:

- Cutting too close to the trunk
 - Leaving long stubs
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Demo Scenario

Cutting a small mango branch:

- Smooth angled cut → heals fast
 - Rough cut → slows healing
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Lesson 3.3 – Pruning Small Trees

Focus Areas

- Shape the tree early
 - Maintain strong structure
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Key Goal

Create a tree with:

- Strong central stem
 - Evenly spaced branches
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Example

Young citrus tree:

- Too many low branches → weak structure
 - After pruning → stronger upward growth
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Lesson 3.4 – Common Beginner Mistakes

Mistakes to Avoid

Over-pruning

- Removing too many branches at once

Using dull tools

- Causes damage and disease

cutting angle (wrong angle)

- Leads to poor healing

Ignoring tree shape

- Results in unbalanced growth
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Example

Bad practice:

- Cutting 50% of branches at once
Tree becomes stressed

Correct practice:

- Remove only necessary branches
Tree stays healthy
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Lesson 3.5 – Practice Activity

Activity: Branch Identification

Look at a tree and identify:

- 2 dead branches
- 2 weak branches
- 1 healthy branch (DO NOT CUT)